

Denialism and Contrarianism

A Double-Edged Receipt Analysis of Asymmetric Negative Promotion

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Scope. This paper defines adjudicative failure modes. It does not infer motive, diagnose persons, or make the truth of a disputed proposition follow from defects in its rejection. The same tests apply reflexively to accusations of denialism or contrarianism.

Abstract

Denialism and contrarianism are often used as psychological or rhetorical labels. That usage is difficult to audit and easy to weaponize. This paper instead gives them operational meanings inside a receipt-governed adjudication system. A proposition may be withheld when its receipt is inadequate; its negation may be promoted only when the negative claim itself is adequately receipted, axiomatic by declaration, or licensed by a stated completeness rule. Denialism is defined here as asymmetric negative promotion: withholding a proposition for want of warrant while promoting its negation, or a rejection that entails its negation, through an unreceipted load-bearing premise. Contrarianism is defined as side- or polarity-dependent burden escalation: opposition itself changes the applicable burden, acceptance rule, or stopping rule without a registered and adequately supported distinction. Neither classification establishes the disputed proposition. Both classify the adjudication. Exchange, restoration, and reflexive tests make the scheme falsifiable against its own accusations.

1. Formal setting

Let C be a registered claim. Its truth-material registration is an extensible tuple

$$\text{sigma}(C) = \langle P, A, D, Q, G, K, M, I \rangle,$$

where P is propositional content, A attribution, D domain, Q quantifier structure/order, G grain or resolution, K conditions/context, M modal or epistemic status, and I inferential strength. Let R be a receipt; $J(R)$ its supported jurisdiction; $\text{Adeq}(R, C)$ mean that R is adequate for C at the registered scope; $\text{Dep}(C)$ be the load-bearing dependencies of C ; and S be an adjudication rule. The adjudication rule S is not itself a proposition coordinate.

Receipt rule R0. No non-axiomatic load-bearing dependency may be silently promoted without an adequate receipt or explicit OPEN/conditional status.

2. Double-edged requirement

If S requires $\text{Adeq}(R_G, G)$ before promoting G , consistency forbids S from promoting $\text{not-}G$, or a rejection entailing $\text{not-}G$, through a load-bearing non-axiomatic premise B for which no adequate receipt is supplied. The permissible consequence of inadequate warrant for G is therefore non-promotion of G , not automatic promotion of $\text{not-}G$.

$$\text{not Adeq}(R_G, G) \Rightarrow \text{do not promote}(G)$$

$$\text{not Adeq}(R_G, G) \not\Rightarrow \text{promote}(\text{not-}G)$$

This result is deliberately non-vindicatory: exposing a defective rejection does not prove the rejected claim. It restores the disputed proposition to the status warranted by its own receipts, which may be TRUE-at-scope, FALSE-at-scope, conditional, or OPEN.

3. Definitions

3.1 Structural denialism

Definition D1 (denialism). Relative to a declared receipt rule S , denialism with respect to G occurs when all of the following hold: (i) G is denied promotion or treated as defeated for want of adequate warrant; (ii) not- G , or a rejection E that entails not- G at the registered scope, is promoted; (iii) that negative promotion depends on at least one non-axiomatic load-bearing premise B ; and (iv) B lacks an adequate receipt, an explicit axiomatic declaration, or a valid registered closure/completeness license.

$DEN_S(G) := Withhold_S(G) \text{ AND } Promote_S(E) \text{ AND } (E \Rightarrow \text{not-}G) \text{ AND } \text{exists } B \text{ in } Dep(E): \text{Unlicensed}(B)$

Here $Unlicensed(B)$ means that B is neither adequately receipted, explicitly axiomatic, nor retained as conditional/OPEN. D1 classifies an inferential structure, not a speaker. A person can produce a denialistic adjudication without denialism being asserted as a trait, identity, intention, or diagnosis.

3.2 Structural contrarianism

Definition C1 (contrarianism). Let $iota$ index relational position, polarity, or side, such as proponent/challenger, familiar/unfamiliar, SELF/OTHER, or affirmative/negative. Contrarianism occurs when the applicable adjudicative burden changes as a function of opposition or side identity while the registered claim, receipt, scope, and every independently relevant condition are held fixed, and no adequately supported distinction licenses the change.

Symmetric rule: $S(C) = f(\text{sigma}(C), R)$

Contrarian witness: $S(C) = f(\text{sigma}(C), R, \text{iota})$, with $\Delta_{\text{iota}} S \neq 0$ and iota unlicensed

Contrarianism need not entail a negative conclusion. It can manifest as moving burdens, asymmetric stopping rules, selective demands for universality, or acceptance of an objection under a weaker evidentiary rule than the proposition it defeats. Denialism and contrarianism therefore overlap but are not identical.

4. Relationship among skepticism, refutation, denialism, and contrarianism

State	What it licenses	Receipt condition
Skepticism	Withhold G ; retain OPEN/conditional status.	No negative receipt required unless a negative claim is promoted.
Refutation	Promote not- G or a defeater of G .	Negative conclusion and its load-bearing premises satisfy the applicable receipt rule.
Denialism (D1)	Treat failure of G to earn promotion as warrant for a negative conclusion.	Fails the same receipt discipline invoked against G .
Contrarianism (C1)	Change burden because of side/oppositional position.	No registered, adequately supported distinction licenses the burden change.

5. Theorems and proofs

Theorem 1 - Negative-promotion symmetry

Assume R0 and a receipt-governed S. If S withholds G because its required receipt is inadequate, S cannot consistently promote a conclusion E entailing not-G when E depends load-bearingly on an unlicensed premise B.

Proof. Promotion of E makes each load-bearing B in Dep(E) adjudicatively operative. By R0, every such non-axiomatic B must have an adequate receipt or remain explicit as conditional/OPEN. If an unlicensed B is nevertheless used to promote E while G is withheld under R0, S applies its declared receipt rule asymmetrically. Therefore the promotion is inconsistent with S. QED.

Theorem 2 - Non-vindication

A successful denialism witness against the rejection of G does not entail G.

Proof. The witness establishes a defect in the derivation or licensing of E. Removing an invalid route to not-G supplies no receipt for G. Hence the admissible consequence is to retract or weaken E and re-adjudicate G on its own receipts. QED.

Theorem 3 - Exchange witness for contrarianism

Let E_i exchange only the side index ι while preserving $\sigma(C)$, R, the evidence, and every registered relevant condition. If S(E_i(C)) differs from S(C), and no independently supported distinction makes ι relevant, then S depends on an unlicensed side index.

Proof. By construction, every licensed input to S is invariant under E_i. A changed burden or verdict therefore requires dependence on ι or an omitted relevant variable. If a proposed omitted variable is subsequently registered and adequately supported, the witness is defeated as a side-only witness. Otherwise side-index dependence remains. QED.

Theorem 4 - Reflexive liability

An accusation of denialism or contrarianism receives no exemption from R0. It must identify the registered claims, the allegedly unequal burdens, the negative promotion or side exchange, and the load-bearing unreceipted premise. If restoration or registration of a relevant distinction removes the alleged asymmetry, the accusation fails.

Proof. The accusation is itself a claim under S. Exempting it from R0 would instantiate the very privilege the framework prohibits. QED.

6. Mechanical tests

Test A - Negative-promotion audit. Register G and the actual negative conclusion E. Determine whether E entails not-G at the same D, Q, G, K, M, and I coordinates. Enumerate Dep(E). For each load-bearing B, demand the same class of receipt that S declares necessary for comparable promotion. A missing receipt does not prove G; it blocks promotion of E.

Test B - Side exchange. Hold $\sigma(C)$, R, evidence, and licensed conditions fixed. Exchange only ι . If the burden changes, record side-index dependence. Before classifying C1, permit the adjudicator to register a proposed relevant distinction and supply its receipt. If that succeeds, the difference is no longer attributable merely to side identity.

Test C - Restoration. Where the rejection changes a truth-material coordinate, restore the disputed claim to its registered coordinates. If the negative inference disappears, the objection concerned a

different proposition. This is semantic substitution, not necessarily D1 or C1; multiple failure modes may coexist.

Test D - Reflexive reversal. Reverse proponent and challenger, and apply D1/C1 to the accusation itself. A framework that excuses its own unsupported negative promotions is self-defeating by its own rule.

7. Hard cases and boundaries

Closed-world and completeness licenses. Finite non-observation can warrant a negative conclusion when a justified completeness rule makes absence evidentially decisive - for example, an exhaustive finite enumeration under a registered domain. D1 therefore requires absence of such a license; it does not prohibit negative inference from absence in principle.

Different claims may bear different burdens. Symmetry does not mean identical evidence for materially different propositions. Universal, existential, causal, modal, and probabilistic claims can require different receipts. C1 is triggered only when the difference tracks an unlicensed side index rather than a registered truth-material distinction.

Prior probabilities and background knowledge. A declared evidentiary system may legitimately incorporate priors or background premises. Those premises become part of the adjudicative registration and remain open to receipt audit at the level where they are load-bearing. Hidden background assumptions cannot function as an invisible exemption.

Suspension is not denialism. Refusing assent, asking for replication, lowering confidence, or leaving a proposition OPEN does not satisfy D1 unless a negative conclusion is promoted through an unlicensed dependency. Persistent disagreement is not by itself contrarianism unless the burden demonstrably depends on opposition or side identity.

Error does not imply motive. D1 and C1 establish structural properties of an adjudication. They do not establish bad faith, ideology, stubbornness, deception, pathology, or intent.

8. Minimal falsifiable receipt

To sustain a D1/C1 classification, supply: the exact positive claim G; the exact negative conclusion E; their registrations and scopes; the declared receipt rule; the receipts actually demanded and accepted; the load-bearing dependency alleged to be unreceipted; and, for contrarianism, an exchange in which only the unlicensed side index changes. Any supported truth-material distinction that explains the burden difference defeats the side-only witness.

9. Consequence for review and adjudication

A reviewer is entitled to reject inadequate evidence, identify unsupported inference, demand stronger receipts, or leave a claim unaccepted. The reviewer is not thereby committed to accepting the claim. But once the review promotes a negative conclusion, the negative conclusion enters the same receipt jurisdiction. "I am unconvinced" can terminate assent; it cannot silently become "therefore false" without an additional license. Likewise, a challenge may be stringent, but its stringency cannot depend merely on which side is being challenged unless that distinction is registered and supported.

This is the double edge. It cuts unsupported generation and unsupported nullification with the same rule. The framework therefore offers neither a refuge for proponents nor a weapon against skeptics: it

protects the boundary between non-demonstration and demonstration of absence, and between legitimate differential burdens and unlicensed side privilege.

10. Conclusion

Denialism and contrarianism can be made technically useful only by removing their dependence on guesses about psychology. In this paper, denialism is asymmetric negative promotion under a receipt rule; contrarianism is unlicensed side-dependent burden variation. Both are mechanically testable, defeasible classifications of adjudication. Neither proves the proposition they may have been used against. Their strongest safeguard is reflexivity: the accusation must survive the same receipt, exchange, scope, and restoration requirements it imposes on the adjudication it criticizes. A criticism that defeats the framework while preserving the registered claim is admitted; a relevant receipted distinction dissolves an alleged asymmetry; and unresolved residue remains OPEN. What the scheme excludes is narrower: the silent conversion of doubt into negative warrant, or opposition into an evidentiary privilege.

Source basis and relation to TF-NE10

This technical note is a standalone derivation from the receipt-governed architecture formalized in the TF-NE10 Twin Flame VAJRA Technical Companion and its matched Finite Ecological Closure Demonstrator. In particular it uses the Double-Edged Receipt Theorem, the separation of proposition registration from adjudication standard S, mechanical side-index dependence, semantic restoration, and the rule that motive is not inferred from structural dependence. The present names “denialism” and “contrarianism” are additional operational classifications introduced here; they are not reported experimental findings of TF-NE10.